

Chapter 179 Part 1: Extra Story 2-1

On the way back that day, Liang Shi kept ignoring Mumu.

It very much gave off a feeling of "I don't want to know you."

Mumu nestled beside Xu Qingzhu, glancing at Liang Shi's expression from time to time, occasionally calling out coquettishly: "Mama~"

Liang Shi would just make a sound through her nose: "Hm?"

Completely different from usual.

Xu Qingzhu didn't mediate between them either, just watching the two of them carry on.

Mumu also knew she had done wrong. After getting home, she grabbed a box of cookies and ran to Liang Shi, who was sitting on the sofa reading a script. "Mama~ have some cookies."

Liang Shi: "Not hungry."

Mumu: "....."

After a while, she moved a small stool over, opened the refrigerator, took out an apple, then moved the stool to the sink to wash it, and ran to the sofa to give it to Liang Shi: "Mama, have an apple~"

Liang Shi was expressionless: "Don't want to eat."

A few minutes later, Mumu huffily went to complain to Xu Qingzhu, "Mommy, your wife is so hard to coax~"

She deliberately drew out her tone, as if acting cute.

Xu Qingzhu was pouring water for them in the kitchen. After hearing this, she walked to the doorway and asked very seriously: "Then what should we do?"

"Mama!" Mumu climbed into Liang Shi's arms, hugged her neck, and planted a kiss on her face. "If you keep this up, you're going to lose me."

Liang Shi was amused in her heart and wanted to laugh, but she had to hold it in on the surface. She pursed her lips and said: "Then just lose you then."

Mumu: "?"

Mumu planted another kiss on her other cheek. "Mama, I was wrong."

"What were you wrong about?" Liang Shi asked.

"I shouldn't argue with women." Mumu said: "You women are all so strange~ You clearly played my grandma yourself, but you get angry when I call you grandma."

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu was laughing so hard at the kitchen doorway that she was doubled over.

Liang Shi couldn't hold it in either. There was laughter in the corners of her eyes, but she still kept a straight face and poked Mumu's forehead: "What are you even saying?"

"It was written in the script." Mumu said: "It was Mama Yang's line, saying women are really so strange, clearly wanting something but pushing it a thousand miles away."

She even imitated it perfectly, copying Yang Shuyan's tone.

Yang Shuyan had mixed in a bit of Sichuan-Chongqing dialect¹ in that movie, and Mumu had learned it all.

Liang Shi helplessly pressed her forehead and gave her a pat on the bottom, without using any force.

Even so, the little one pouted and looked at Liang Shi with an aggrieved expression, making it seem like Liang Shi was bullying her.

Liang Shi spoke to her very seriously: "From now on, you can't call me grandma. Acting is acting, life is life—you need to separate them."

Mumu's eyes darted around.

Liang Shi didn't know if she could understand, but anyway, she nodded at the time and admitted her mistake with a particularly good attitude: "Mama, I won't do it again."

Liang Shi was finally satisfied.

But that night before bed, Xu Qingzhu took the two little ones to wash up. Liang Shi was on the phone with her agent discussing her upcoming schedule. Before she finished the call, she suddenly felt a fluffy little head rubbing against her leg, which gave her quite a scare.

Liang Shi turned around and found it was Mumu with teary eyes.

She immediately squatted down, brushed her messy hair to the side—finally not looking like a little lunatic anymore—and asked gently: "What's wrong, baby? Why are you crying? Did you fight with your sister again?"

"No." Mumu hugged her neck and apologized in her milky voice: "Mama, I'm sorry, I'll never say you're grandma again."

Liang Shi: "?"

Mumu admitted her mistake while crying with snot and tears, making Liang Shi feel so heartbroken that she coaxed her for quite a while.

Before bed, she went to tell them the story of "The Little Prince."

After hearing it, Mumu was still crying with little hiccups.

After returning to the room, Liang Shi asked Xu Qingzhu what had happened—had she lectured Mumu again?

Xu Qingzhu shrugged, "I just showed her a video."

"What?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu played the video she had saved on her phone. It was the most profound crying scene from when they were filming "You in My Memory."

Liang Shi, wearing elderly makeup, sat in a chair facing the sunset, sitting there alone and crying.

That was the most emotionally draining scene in that movie.

Although Mumu had also acted in that movie, she had few scenes with Liang Shi. Most of the time she was filming with Yang Shuyan. Occasionally when she was with Liang Shi, she would see her elderly makeup, but usually just found it fun.

When this scene was being filmed, Mumu and the others were still playing at kindergarten.

So they didn't see it, but Xu Qingzhu was there at the time, so she had recorded this segment on her phone.

This segment was filmed twice. After the first take, the crying emotion wasn't quite right.

By the second take, when the camera pulled in for a close-up, Liang Shi's eyes showed the aged weariness, the hesitation, the confusion, the helplessness, the lingering attachment to this world, and the fear of death—all portrayed vividly and thoroughly.

As if she would pass away the very next second.

Although this scene had no sound, it particularly tested one's acting skills.

Because they were recording live audio on set and the set was quiet, when everyone watched her perform this scene, basically everyone was moved to tears.

And Liang Shi, because she was too immersed in the role, couldn't come out of it.

From the initial restrained crying, to later covering her face and crying, to finally sobbing out loud—she cried for nearly twenty minutes before filming was complete.

Even after filming ended, she still sat there crying, unable to stop at all.

When Xu Qingzhu went over to talk to her, she was in a completely dazed state, her teary eyes looking at Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu spoke to her, "Wife."

Liang Shi looked at her, suddenly leaned forward to embrace her, buried herself in her neck, and burst into loud sobs.

"Xu Qingzhu." Liang Shi cried out her name, while Xu Qingzhu stroked her back over and over.

But Liang Shi said to her: "Take me home, wuwuwu....."

Xu Qingzhu stood up with her, but when she tried to lead her away, Liang Shi wouldn't move—she just stood in place hugging her and crying.

But so as not to hinder the staff from packing up the set, Xu Qingzhu gently negotiated with her: "Baby, shall we go stand over there?"

Liang Shi then picked her up and carried her to another empty spot, continuing to bury herself in her neck and cry.

She cried for nearly half an hour before she finally recovered. Liang Shi's voice was completely hoarse.

Later, Xu Qingzhu asked her, "What were you thinking about that made you cry so sadly?"

Liang Shi sniffled, her voice hoarse from just having cried, with a heavy nasal tone: "I was thinking about how you'll outlive me, and after I'm gone, you'll be left all alone, by yourself... I felt so awful."

Liang Shi didn't want to cry anymore, but talking about this still made her heart ache, and she stomped her feet in frustration.

-
1. Sichuan-Chongqing dialect (川渝方言) refers to the regional dialect spoken in Sichuan Province and Chongqing Municipality in southwestern China. It has distinctive tones and vocabulary that differ from standard Mandarin, and is often used in entertainment to add local flavor or comedic effect. ↩

Chapter 179 Part 2: Extra Story 2-2

"Xu Qingzhu." Liang Shi said: "From now on, don't get old....."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"How can a person not get old?" Xu Qingzhu said: "Birth, aging, sickness, and death are all normal, aren't they?"

Liang Shi's eyes were red, and she shook her head very seriously: "You're not allowed to get old."

Xu Qingzhu was helpless and could only coax her: "Okay, I won't get old."

Only then did Liang Shi nod: "Okay."

Still looking aggrieved, her voice soft and childlike.

After Xu Qingzhu showed Mumu that video of Liang Shi's crying scene, Mumu cried her eyes out, repeatedly saying: "I don't want Mama to get old."

Chaochao didn't have as strong an empathetic response to this kind of video, but she still got red eyes and secretly wiped away tears.

Xu Qingzhu then said to Mumu: "Grandma is one of the characters Mama created, but it's not her. If you call her grandma, she'll be very sad, just as sad as in the video."

Mumu immediately ran to find Liang Shi to apologize.

Thinking about how hard Mumu had cried, Liang Shi still felt a bit soft-hearted and said in a low voice: "They're still young and don't understand these things. Showing them these videos made them cry too hard."

Xu Qingzhu was reading a book. Hearing this, she looked up and directly called her out: "You just feel sorry for them."

Liang Shi: "....."

She had nothing to say in response.

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her: "Sooner or later you're going to spoil your daughters rotten!"

Hearing this, Liang Shi got into bed, lifting the covers to get in: "Aren't they your daughters too?"

Xu Qingzhu: ".....It's you who spoils them too much."

"How can children grow up if they're not spoiled?" Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu: ".....Then just let her keep calling you grandma."

Liang Shi: "That's not appropriate!"

"Anyway, you can tolerate them doing anything." Xu Qingzhu argued with her: "Daughter slave."¹

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi reached out and lightly pinched her waist, "How am I?"

Xu Qingzhu scoffed lightly: "Those two never do anything wrong. As long as you're around, whatever they do is always right."

Liang Shi: "They're just well-behaved to begin with."

Xu Qingzhu closed her book and set it aside, staring straight at her: "It's your filter that's too strong—after all, they're your little cuties and little darlings."

Liang Shi: "....."

After having children for several years, Liang Shi had long been able to hear all the subtext in Xu Qingzhu's words.

At this moment, she didn't know whether to laugh or cry.

She moved close to Xu Qingzhu, her arm resting on her waist, her fingers already undoing the bow on her pajamas.

The silk pajamas slid open smoothly.

Liang Shi's head happened to rest on her shoulder, the warm breath from her words all exhaled onto her collarbone, traveling up along the collarbone, making Xu Qingzhu's skin feel a bit ticklish. She raised her hand to cover that area.

But Liang Shi called out clingy: "Baby~"

Xu Qingzhu's ears grew hot, feigning calm: "What?"

"How can you even be jealous of the children?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu grabbed her hand and asked back: "So what?"

Liang Shi lightly pursed her lips, leaned over and kissed her on the lips: "Although I love them very much, the one I love most is still you."

"That mouth of yours just deceives people." Xu Qingzhu remained unmoved.

Liang Shi leaned over to kiss her, "How so? I'm serious."

As she spoke, she had already pulled her down, and the pajamas on her body slid off accordingly.

Liang Shi tossed the pajamas aside, leaving only a black camisole.

She had been working hard at the gym lately to prepare for her next drama, and her arm definition and ab lines were well-developed.

Her hands also pinned Xu Qingzhu to the bed.

Xu Qingzhu's seaweed-like long hair spread across the bed, her eyes staring straight at her.

"How serious?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi thought for a moment and said earnestly: "Baby, I love you."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

The corners of Xu Qingzhu's mouth unconsciously curved up, but immediately curved back down again. "How much do you love me?"

Liang Shi pursed her lips, leaned down to kiss her, nuzzling against her lips, "I love you so so much, every day when I think of you I feel so happy."

Xu Qingzhu knew this was already the sweetest words of love Liang Shi could say, so she didn't make things difficult for her.

But she still held out a little longer, saying in a cold voice: "Fine then."

The last word had an upward inflection.

Liang Shi looked at her hand and suddenly said gently: "Baby, spread your five fingers."

Xu Qingzhu was puzzled: "What for?"

Although puzzled in her heart, Xu Qingzhu still did as asked.

Because her wrist was held by Liang Shi, positioned just above her head, Xu Qingzhu slowly spread her slender, fair fingers.

Liang Shi said: "Did you see it?"

Xu Qingzhu: "What?"

Liang Shi's earlobes were so red they looked like they might drip blood: "You just set off a grand fireworks display in my heart."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"Crackling and popping." Liang Shi leaned down to her ear and said in a breathy voice: "My heart is about to be exploded by you."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu's entire face suddenly flushed bright red, the corners of her mouth curving up continuously.

1. "女儿奴" (nǚ'ér nú) literally means "daughter slave" and is a popular Chinese internet slang term used to describe a parent (often the father, but applicable to any parent) who dotes excessively on their daughter(s) and would do anything for them. It's similar to the English concept of being "wrapped around someone's finger." ⇐